



About Green Key Global

Green Key Global, owned by the **Hotel Association of Canada (HAC)** and the **American Hotel & Lodging Association (AHLA)**, is a leading certification body empowering hospitality businesses in North America to achieve excellence in sustainability. Our globally recognized Best-in-Class solutions ensure that our members meet high international standards, leveraging corporate social responsibility and environmental social governance, gaining a competitive edge in the eco-conscious market. By aligning with all **17 of the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, Green Key Global sets a comprehensive standard for sustainability practices. Join us as we lead the way towards a more sustainable future for the hospitality industry!



Sustainability is becoming increasingly important to business owners and guests when making travel choices.



We are here to help you **celebrate every milestone of your journey** and map out future endeavors to continually improve.



North American hospitality industry's sustainability certification body of choice, offering standardized programs, resources and tools.



Corporate and individual travelers, event planners, and attendees are now **demanding a certified level of sustainability** in their accommodation choices.



In partnership with **One Tree Planted**, a tree is planted for every new member.



From the climate crisis to the consumer influence, corporate sustainability targets, brand commitments, and OTA requirements, **Green Key Global Certification validates sustainability claims.**

Green Key Global members benefit on several fronts:



cost savings



increased bookings



reduced carbon footprint

The Basic Principals of Green Key Global Certification:



Assesses Your Unique Needs

- ☐ The Green Key Eco-Rating Program offers a rigorous online self-assessment with questions measuring specific operational areas including corporate environmental management (front of house), housekeeping, food & beverage, conference & meeting facilities, and engineering.
- ☐ Upon completing the Eco-Rating self-assessment, a third-party audit is to be conducted by Green Key Global's audit partner, Control Union, then an official rating is awarded. These audits are vital to ensuring that a member's answers are an accurate reflection of their actions.
- ☐ Members re-assess every three years in order to maintain certification and stay up to date with industry standards.



Awarding Your Eco-Rating

- ☐ Based on the results of the comprehensive self-assessment and third-party audit, lodging facilities are awarded a rating from 1 to 5 Keys (5-Keys being the highest attainable). This can be promoted through a Green Key Global certificate or personalized plaque.



A Balanced Solution

- ☐ The Green Key Global Eco-Rating Program analyses important areas of sustainable application practices in your facility, including:



Energy conservation



Community outreach



Water conservation



Building infrastructure



Solid waste management



Land use



Hazardous waste management



Environmental management



Indoor air quality



Industry Priorities for Sustainability

- ☐ Green Key Global assessment criteria is in alignment with the United Nation SDGs.
- ☐ OTA's, government procurement officers, and RFP platforms are sent the list of certified properties through Green Key Global on an automated basis which will allow travelers and planners the ability to see which properties are certified in sustainability when using third-party booking platforms.



Market Sustainable Action

- ☐ A variety of marketing materials are available to members in the Marketing Toolkit to assist in the promotion of their sustainability initiatives as well as a selection of tools and resources to support their ongoing sustainable programs. The initiatives can be showcased through Green Key Global social media channels, website, and e-newsletter.



What It Means to Be Green Key Certified:

- ☐ Property has a sustainability policy and action plan in place
- ☐ All departments achieve a high level of sustainability process and practice
- ☐ Regularly audited by an accredited auditor
- ☐ Aligned with 17 of the United Nation's Sustainable Development Goals
- ☐ Hotel factors the following into everyday procedure
 - ☐ Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG)
 - ☐ Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)
 - ☐ Regenerative Tourism
 - ☐ Diversity
- ☐ A Green Team has been assigned at the property level to maintain certification levels in all areas of the hotel
- ☐ Sustainability practices are communicated to guests and staff
- ☐ Energy savings, waste management, and water conservation systems meet the industry standards
- ☐ Greenhouse gases and carbon emissions are monitored and measured
- ☐ Hotel practices and processes contribute to the well-being of the local community
- ☐ Hotel has signed a sustainability pledge commitment to benefit the environment



Green Key Global standards are regularly updated to stay in line with the latest sustainability best practices

We look forward to connecting with you about how Green Key Global can help your business.

